

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Case Study Method and Answer Architecture - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Case Study Method and Answer Architecture

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Eight-element architecture: from verified facts to residual risk

2 Six ethical checks: hard thresholds before weighted balancing

3 Nested dilemmas, steelmanning and the residual-risk close

4 Improper pressure, ethical dissent, whistleblowing and resignation

5 Triage, scarce resources and competency-based case practice

6 Worked mechanism: DC Vijay and integrated decision architecture

7 Domain adaptation across public, corporate and professional cases

8 Prelims facts, examiner traps and representative PYQ routing

9 Mains analysis, probable demands and time-bound answer design

10 Study links, recent cases, historical cases and final synthesis

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Generation: learner-v2:g1 **PYQ ownership:** Questions labelled as official reproduce the locally held UPSC GS-IV papers; routed historical demands are explicitly neutral renderings rather than invented quotations.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

An officer assumes a contractor bribed a superior merely because they met privately. What initial discipline is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- B. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.
- C. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- D. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.

Answer: A

Explanation: Facts must be separated from assumptions is the controlling principle. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 2

A candidate labels disputed claims as unverified and states what must be checked before action. Which architectural element is being applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- B. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- C. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.
- D. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.

Answer: B

Explanation: Facts must be separated from assumptions is the controlling principle. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 3

A forest-diversion answer lists officials and applicants but ignores tribal livelihoods, biodiversity and future residents. What mapping defect appears? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- B. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- C. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.
- D. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.

Answer: C

Explanation: Stakeholder mapping includes silent parties is the controlling principle. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 4

A procurement answer includes patients, rival bidders and public trust although none speaks in the narrative. Which disciplined practice does this show? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- B. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.
- C. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- D. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.

Answer: D

Explanation: Stakeholder mapping includes silent parties is the controlling principle. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 5

A district officer promises immediate national legislation to resolve a local emergency. Which overlooked element makes the promise unusable? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- B. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- C. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.
- D. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Hard constraints eliminate impossible choices early** is the controlling principle. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 6

A field engineer distinguishes emergency stabilisation within delegated power from a permanent repair requiring superior sanction. Which reasoning step is decisive? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.
- B. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- C. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.
- D. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Hard constraints eliminate impossible choices early** is the controlling principle. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 7

A response offers only obey or resign, although written dissent and lawful escalation remain available. Which architectural weakness does this reveal? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- B. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.
- C. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.
- D. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.

Answer: C

Explanation: Options require realistic comparison is the controlling principle. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 8

A disaster answer compares immediate departure, total abstention, brief delegated absence and remote oversight before deciding. Which option discipline is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Stakeholder mapping must include direct participants and less visible parties such as future generations, absent beneficiaries, vulnerable groups and the institution whose long-term credibility may be altered by the decision.
- B. Legal authority, delegation limits, time, verified information, jurisdiction and actual capacity should be mapped before generating options; a proposal that breaches a binding constraint is not a realistic administrative choice.
- C. A disciplined case answer restates only verified facts, identifies uncertainty and avoids silently inventing motives, powers or resources; later options and judgments must remain traceable to what the scenario actually establishes.
- D. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course.

Answer: D

Explanation: Options require realistic comparison is the controlling principle. A strong answer develops at least three feasible courses, including a sequenced or hybrid response where useful, and states one concrete advantage and disadvantage before selecting the most defensible course. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 9

An officer proposes unlawful data disclosure because it could speed an investigation. Which check defeats the proposal before benefits are weighed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- B. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.
- C. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- D. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Legality operates as a hard threshold** is the controlling principle. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 10

A candidate first removes sanction evasion and then compares lawful urgent responses. Which evaluation sequence is correct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- B. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- C. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.
- D. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Legality operates as a hard threshold** is the controlling principle. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 11

A committee chair evaluates her brother's bid because management trusts her judgment. Which threshold has been ignored? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- B. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- C. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.
- D. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.

Answer: C

Explanation: Conflict of interest is near-disqualifying is the controlling principle. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 12

An official records a family link and stops influencing that tender while continuing other duties. Which principle is correctly applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- B. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.
- C. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- D. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.

Answer: D

Explanation: Conflict of interest is near-disqualifying is the controlling principle. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 13

Scarce beds could maximise lives saved yet disadvantage a vulnerable group. What must the answer do beyond listing both values? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- B. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- C. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.
- D. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.

Answer: A

Explanation: Weighted checks require an explicit priority is the controlling principle. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 14

A crisis response prioritises proportionality while adding honest communication and a grievance route. Which balancing method is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.
- B. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- C. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.
- D. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.

Answer: B

Explanation: Weighted checks require an explicit priority is the controlling principle. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 15

A candidate cites compassion alone without testing duty, effects or character. Which evaluative layer remains incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- B. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.
- C. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.
- D. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.

Answer: C

Explanation: Moral theories test surviving options is the controlling principle. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 16

A response compares role duty, likely public harm and practical wisdom before choosing a hybrid course. Which combined method is being used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A genuine personal, family or financial interest requires disclosure and withdrawal from the specific decision; confidence in one's own honesty cannot cure the appearance or structural risk of biased authority.
- B. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion may pull in different directions; the candidate should state which consideration is decisive in context and explain why the remaining concerns are mitigated rather than denied.
- C. An unlawful option is normally eliminated before ethical balancing, even when it appears compassionate or efficient; claimed benefits cannot convert absence of lawful authority into a permissible administrative response.
- D. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker.

Answer: D

Explanation: Moral theories test surviving options is the controlling principle. After threshold screening, deontology tests duties and rights, consequentialism compares foreseeable outcomes, and virtue ethics asks what integrity, courage, compassion and practical wisdom require from the decision-maker. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 17

A disaster answer treats personal grief as the only issue and ignores delegation fairness and public communication. Which technique was omitted? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- B. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.
- C. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- D. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Nested dilemmas should be solved separately** is the controlling principle. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 18

A candidate resolves command continuity, relief allocation and crisis communication separately, then integrates them. Which advanced discipline is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- B. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- C. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.
- D. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Nested dilemmas should be solved separately** is the controlling principle. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 19

A sustainability proposal ignores the risk that costly commitments could destroy competitiveness. Which stress test is absent? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- B. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- C. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.
- D. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.

Answer: C

Explanation: Steelmanning uses the strongest objection is the controlling principle. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 20

A decision adds time-bound milestones after accepting that an unlimited transition could be commercially destructive. Which reasoning device is applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- B. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.
- C. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- D. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.

Answer: D

Explanation: Steelmanning uses the strongest objection is the controlling principle. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 21

An answer ends with justice will prevail and names no remaining danger. Which closing discipline is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- B. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- C. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.
- D. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.

Answer: A

Explanation: Residual risk must name monitoring and accountability is the controlling principle. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 22

A delegated disaster command is followed by scheduled check-ins and a review led by the returning officer. Which closing formula is present? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.
- B. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- C. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.
- D. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.

Answer: B

Explanation: Residual risk must name monitoring and accountability is the controlling principle. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 23

A candidate lists safeguards but never asks what danger remains if one safeguard fails. Which conceptual lens would improve the close? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- B. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.
- C. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.
- D. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.

Answer: C

Explanation: Residual risk can be expressed as a control formula is the controlling principle. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 24

A response names inherent retaliation risk, protection controls and the remaining exposure after those controls. Which formula is being operationalised? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Before closing, the answer should present the most credible objection to its chosen course and either defeat it with reasons or modify implementation to absorb its valid concern without abandoning the decision.
- B. A mature conclusion identifies the specific harm that may survive the preferred course, names a review or monitoring mechanism and assigns responsibility to a person or institution rather than claiming complete resolution.
- C. When a scenario contains analytically distinct tensions, each should receive a compact independent evaluation before the answers are recombined; this prevents one emotional conflict from obscuring resource, transparency or legality questions.
- D. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic.

Answer: D

Explanation: Residual risk can be expressed as a control formula is the controlling principle. Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by effective controls, while uncertainty and control failure remain visible; the expression disciplines mitigation but does not pretend ethical judgment can be reduced to arithmetic. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 25

A procurement chair tells colleagues about her family link but continues scoring bids. Which steps remain incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- B. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.
- C. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- D. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.

Answer: A

Explanation: Conflict resolution follows **disclose, recuse, refer, publish** is the controlling principle. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 26

A superior appoints an unconflicted committee that applies pre-announced criteria after the original chair withdraws. Which sequence is completed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- B. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- C. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.
- D. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.

Answer: B

Explanation: Conflict resolution follows **disclose, recuse, refer, publish** is the controlling principle. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 27

A minister pressures an engineer verbally and the engineer merely refuses in private. Which protective administrative response is absent? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- B. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- C. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.
- D. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.

Answer: C

Explanation: Improper oral pressure should be converted into writing is the controlling principle. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 28

A professional records the instruction, technical risk and request for confirmation before escalating. Which method is correctly used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- B. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.
- C. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- D. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.

Answer: D

Explanation: Improper oral pressure should be converted into writing is the controlling principle. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 29

An employee immediately posts confidential allegations online without testing safe lawful channels. Which escalation discipline was bypassed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- B. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- C. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.
- D. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Ethical dissent climbs a proportionate ladder** is the controlling principle. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 30

A quality officer skips a compromised manager but reports to an independent regulator with preserved evidence. Which rung logic is followed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.
- B. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- C. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.
- D. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Ethical dissent climbs a proportionate ladder** is the controlling principle. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 31

An officer resigns before recording dissent although continued service could still block the wrongful act. Which evaluation error occurs? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- B. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.
- C. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.
- D. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.

Answer: C

Explanation: Resignation is an evaluated last resort is the controlling principle. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 32

An official reserves resignation for a point at which personal execution of an unresolved illegality becomes unavoidable. Which test is applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. An officer facing an improper oral direction should record its substance, seek written confirmation, state the professional objection and use the normal escalation route while continuing lawful duties unless action would itself be unsafe.
- B. Evidence-based dissent normally moves from competent internal reporting to an independent internal tier, then to authorised external channels and only finally to public disclosure when serious continuing harm and failed alternatives justify it.
- C. A conflicted decision-maker should disclose the connection in writing, recuse from that matter, refer it to an untainted authority and ensure objective criteria govern the eventual decision and its defensibility.
- D. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape.

Answer: D

Explanation: Resignation is an evaluated last resort is the controlling principle. Resignation becomes defensible only after lawful resistance and escalation are exhausted or unavailable, and when departure protects public interest better than remaining as a principled internal safeguard; it should not function as emotional escape. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 33

A hospital allocates staff through undocumented personal discretion during a surge. Which triage safeguards are missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- B. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.
- C. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- D. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.

Answer: A

Explanation: Triage criteria should be published and reviewable is the controlling principle. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 34

A relief authority publishes need and vulnerability criteria, logs decisions and revisits them daily. Which method is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- B. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- C. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.
- D. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.

Answer: B

Explanation: Triage criteria should be published and reviewable is the controlling principle. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 35

A candidate calls a severity score ethically neutral although it disadvantages a patient group. Which analysis is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- B. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- C. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.
- D. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.

Answer: C

Explanation: Triage must acknowledge its value trade-off is the controlling principle. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 36

A committee prioritises urgent survivability while auditing disparate impact on vulnerable patients. Which ethical balance is achieved? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- B. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.
- C. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- D. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.

Answer: D

Explanation: Triage must acknowledge its value trade-off is the controlling principle. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 37

A candidate copies a public procurement remedy into a clinical-consent dispute without naming the ethics committee. Which adaptation error occurs? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- B. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- C. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.
- D. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.

Answer: A

Explanation: Domain adaptation preserves the architecture is the controlling principle. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 38

A research case uses the common decision sequence but routes consent and data concerns to the competent ethics body. Which transfer skill is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.
- B. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- C. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.
- D. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.

Answer: B

Explanation: Domain adaptation preserves the architecture is the controlling principle. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 39

A candidate spends most of the answer narrating facts and has no space for implementation. Which time management correction is needed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- B. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.
- C. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.
- D. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.

Answer: C

Explanation: **Time pressure changes depth, not sequence** is the controlling principle. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 40

A twenty-mark response uses short labelled blocks while retaining all eight elements. Which examination principle is followed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A defensible allocation explains whether aggregate welfare, urgency, survivability, vulnerability or priority to the worst-off is being emphasised, then adds equity safeguards so the chosen metric does not become mechanically dehumanising.
- B. The same eight elements apply across administration, corporate governance, policing, research, health and environmental disputes, but legal authority, technical standards, affected stakeholders and competent institutions must be adapted to the domain.
- C. Scarce-resource allocation should use pre-announced, relevant and non-discriminatory criteria, record their actual application, provide an appropriate review route and revise them when resources or the emergency profile materially changes.
- D. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close.

Answer: D

Explanation: **Time pressure changes depth, not sequence** is the controlling principle. Under examination pressure, candidates should compress each architectural element rather than omit it: one-line facts and dilemma, a compact stakeholder-constraint map, three options, decisive checks, action steps and a residual-risk close. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 41

An answer lists every value but refuses to choose among feasible options. Which decision-writing defect remains? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- B. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.
- C. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- D. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.

Answer: A

Explanation: Decision writing should identify the decisive reason is the controlling principle. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 42

A response selects lawful phased repair because urgency and proportionality control after sanction evasion is removed. Which clarity is demonstrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- B. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- C. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.
- D. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.

Answer: B

Explanation: Decision writing should identify the decisive reason is the controlling principle. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 43

A district officer chooses evacuation but never identifies transport, command or public messaging. Which element is incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- B. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- C. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.
- D. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.

Answer: C

Explanation: Implementation must assign actions and audiences is the controlling principle. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 44

A decision names the deputy, written delegation, check-in schedule and public notice. Which implementation discipline is present? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- B. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.
- C. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- D. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.

Answer: D

Explanation: Implementation must assign actions and audiences is the controlling principle. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 45

An administrator repeats an unverified viral claim to appear transparent. Which communication mistake is made? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- B. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- C. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.
- D. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.

Answer: A

Explanation: Communication should be honest and calibrated is the controlling principle. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 46

An official states what is known, what is being checked and when the next update will come. Which weighted balance is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.
- B. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- C. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.
- D. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.

Answer: B

Explanation: Communication should be honest and calibrated is the controlling principle. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 47

A candidate claims the chosen option permanently eliminates every risk. Which concluding flaw appears? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- B. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.
- C. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.
- D. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.

Answer: C

Explanation: A complete answer ends with qualified confidence is the controlling principle. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 48

A response commits to a course while naming review triggers and accountability. Which mature conclusion is being used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Implementation should specify immediate and later actions, competent actors, documentation and communication to seniors, team members and affected people; a morally attractive choice without an execution route remains administratively incomplete.
- B. Crisis communication should disclose verified information, acknowledge uncertainty, prevent avoidable panic and commit to updates; neither premature certainty nor prolonged concealment protects trust when facts are still developing.
- C. A recommendation should name the selected option, the threshold or weighted consideration that controls the choice and the safeguard answering the strongest objection; merely saying balance all interests does not decide the case.
- D. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight.

Answer: D

Explanation: A complete answer ends with qualified confidence is the controlling principle. The final verdict should be decisive but not absolute: it should connect lawful action, public purpose, proportionate safeguards and review, showing confidence in the chosen route while accepting that implementation requires continuing ethical oversight. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q8: a senior Ministry officer with privileged policy knowledge faces a Minister's request to alter a road alignment near the Minister's farm and an offer of land in the officer's wife's name. Analyse the conflict and response.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\more_previous_papers\GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER-IV.pdf, page 7. OCR quality is uneven, so this entry does not claim verbatim reproduction.

Model solution

Facts: A public decision is being pressed toward private ministerial gain, while a benefit is offered through the officer's spouse. **Stakeholders:** road users, affected landholders, taxpayers, the Ministry, the Minister, the officer and family, and institutional trust. **Constraints:** the officer cannot redesign policy for private advantage; official information and delegated authority must be used only for public purpose.

Options: comply and accept the land; refuse orally but leave no record; or decline the benefit, record the request and technical objection, preserve the original evaluation, and refer the matter through the competent hierarchy or vigilance channel. The first option fails legality and conflict-of-interest thresholds. The second is personally clean but institutionally weak. The third best serves legality, public interest and transparency.

Decision: reject the offer, disclose the attempted inducement, avoid any personal participation tainted by it, and insist that alignment be assessed through published technical and social criteria. The strongest objection is that recording a Minister's request may trigger retaliation; that risk does not justify silent compliance and is reduced by contemporaneous documentation and collective technical review.

Implementation: make a dated written note, seek written confirmation of any contrary direction, secure maps and evaluation records, and escalate through the normal reporting and oversight route. **Residual risk:** political transfer or manipulation of later appraisal remains; the Secretary or competent vigilance authority should monitor the record and audit the final alignment decision.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q7: a rescue officer's team is attacked by an angry crowd during a severe natural calamity, and some personnel want operations withdrawn. Evaluate the options and the public-service qualities required.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against

books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-GeneralStudies-IV.pdf, page 4. The official printed scenario controls all details.

Model solution

Facts: essential rescue work faces violence from distressed citizens, and team safety is now part of the operational dilemma. **Stakeholders:** trapped victims, the crowd, rescue staff and families, local administration, police and the wider disaster response. **Constraints:** the duty to rescue continues, but the leader cannot recklessly expose personnel or abandon victims without exploring safer alternatives.

Options: withdraw completely; continue unchanged despite attack; or pause locally, establish security and communication, engage credible community representatives, redesign deployment and resume priority rescue.

Complete withdrawal sacrifices public duty; unchanged deployment is disproportionate to staff risk. The sequenced option best combines courage, empathy, prudence, team leadership and public interest.

Decision: maintain the mission through a safer operational plan. **Steelman:** any pause may cost lives. Therefore the pause must be minimal, rescue of immediately endangered persons must continue where feasible, and police/community liaison must work in parallel rather than sequentially.

Implementation: brief staff, create protected corridors, deploy medical and police support, use local leaders to communicate priorities, document assaults and rotate exhausted teams. **Residual risk:** renewed violence or distrust may disrupt access; the incident commander should maintain live risk review, community liaison and after-action learning while remaining personally accountable for both rescue continuity and team safety.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q7: Finance Ministry officer Rajesh Kumar is pressed to re-appropriate welfare funds toward favoured development projects and must evaluate ethical issues, available options and whether resignation is worthy.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\more_previous_papers\Gen_St_P4.pdf, pages 4-5. Wording is condensed; the local official paper remains authoritative.

Model solution

Facts: a welfare allocation is proposed for re-appropriation to other projects under senior pressure. **Stakeholders:** intended health beneficiaries, project beneficiaries, Parliament, taxpayers, Ministry leadership and Rajesh. **Constraints:** he lacks unilateral authority to stop the decision; procedural permissibility does not itself establish propriety; the budget window is limited.

Options: comply silently; leak externally; resign immediately; or record a reasoned welfare-impact objection, seek written confirmation and escalate through financial, audit and competent oversight channels while continuing lawful duties. Silent compliance fails public interest and transparency. A leak bypasses lawful routes. Immediate resignation removes a principled internal voice before resistance has been tested.

Decision: choose written dissent and time-bound escalation. The decisive checks are public purpose and transparency, because legality may not clearly eliminate the proposal. **Steelman:** internal channels may be captured and delay can consummate diversion. Rajesh should therefore set a short response period and ensure the objection enters the independent audit trail.

Implementation: attach beneficiary and fiscal impact, request a speaking direction, refer to the competent financial authority, and refuse to certify facts he knows are false. Resignation remains a last resort if all lawful channels fail and continued office would compel personal execution or legitimisation of the wrong. **Residual risk:** retaliation or formal

override remains; a named senior financial authority and later audit should review the decision and preserved dissent.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q10: a hospital administrator must devise and justify criteria for deploying scarce clinical and non-clinical staff during a COVID-19 surge and consider whether a private hospital changes the ethical justification.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-21-GENSTUDIESPAPER-IV-110122.pdf, page 8. The official scenario controls the precise subparts.

Model solution

Facts: demand exceeds safe staffing capacity during an infectious-disease emergency. Stakeholders: patients, clinical and non-clinical staff, vulnerable groups, families, management and the public health system. Constraints: skills are not interchangeable, exposure risk is unequal, fatigue impairs care, and decisions must be made rapidly with incomplete forecasts.

Options: deploy volunteers ad hoc; allocate only by seniority; maximise immediate clinical throughput without equity safeguards; or publish clinically relevant criteria covering competence, urgency, exposure, rotation, vulnerability and continuity, with review and grievance mechanisms. Ad hoc and seniority-only methods are arbitrary; pure throughput can devalue vulnerable patients and exhaust staff.

Decision: use transparent, competence-based and equity-audited triage. Consequentialism supports saving the most lives and maintaining service; duty ethics protects non-discrimination and staff safety; compassion requires protection for high-risk workers. Steelman: rigid criteria may become obsolete as the surge changes. A fixed review cycle and incident-command discretion with written reasons answer it.

Implementation: publish the matrix, train deployment teams, provide protective equipment, rotate exposure, preserve surge reserves and communicate individual decisions respectfully. The ethical floor does not fall in a private hospital: ownership may change internal resourcing discretion, not duties of non-discrimination, safety and honest criteria during a public-health emergency. Residual risk: metric bias or sudden absenteeism remains; a multidisciplinary triage committee should audit outcomes daily and revise criteria openly.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q9: an investigative journalist uncovers a stone-mining mafia linked with police, civil officials and political influence, while the media owner pressures the journalist to suppress the report.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against

books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER IV-190922.pdf, page 10. This is a faithful routing, not a verbatim copy.

Model solution

Facts: alleged illegal mining is protected by a network that may compromise ordinary reporting channels, and the journalist faces inducement or suppression. Stakeholders: affected communities, workers, environment, honest officials, sources, the journalist, the media institution and justice agencies. Constraints: allegations need authentication; source safety and evidence integrity may be lost through premature publication; local enforcement may be captured.

Options: suppress the story; publish sensationally at once; resign without preserving evidence; or authenticate and duplicate records, obtain independent legal-editorial review, assess threats, use authorised regulatory or judicial channels, and publish responsibly when source and investigation risks are controlled. Suppression enables harm; impulsive disclosure may expose sources and destroy the case.

Decision: follow a protected dissent ladder, skipping the compromised internal rung but preferring an independent lawful channel before unrestricted disclosure. Steelman: delay allows continuing extraction and evidence destruction. The response therefore requires immediate preservation, parallel referral and a defined publication decision point.

Implementation: keep dated copies, separate source identity, inform an independent editor or professional body, seek security if threats are credible, and route evidence to the competent State authority or court with jurisdiction. Residual risk: retaliation, institutional capture and source exposure remain; an independent legal representative should maintain an access log and review safety and follow-up at fixed intervals.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2023 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q10: an honest IAS officer serving as Managing Director of a State Road Transport Corporation faces a corrupt, politically powerful Chairman and separate pressure from an Opposition party.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against

books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER-IV-180923.pdf, pages 10-11. The official paper remains controlling.

Model solution

Facts: the Managing Director faces suspected corruption from the Chairman and partisan pressure from the Opposition. Stakeholders: commuters, employees, taxpayers, vendors, the Corporation, both political actors and the officer. Constraints: the officer cannot remove the Chairman alone, must verify specific irregularities and must preserve political neutrality while services continue.

Options: comply with the Chairman; hand internal records to the Opposition; resign immediately; or document each irregular direction, seek written clarification, protect decisions within lawful authority and escalate through audit, vigilance and the administrative department. Compliance breaches public trust. A partisan leak compromises neutrality. Resignation is premature while institutional resistance remains.

Decision: choose documented, non-partisan escalation. Legality and procurement propriety screen verified wrongdoing; transparency and public interest guide the response. Steelman: internal channels may be delayed by political influence. The answer is a time-bound referral with independent record preservation, not a political counter-alliance.

Implementation: record oral pressures, seek written orders, decline political sharing outside lawful disclosure, secure procurement records and maintain service delivery. If the normal recipient is compromised, move to the next independent vigilance or statutory tier. Residual risk: transfer, slow-walking and continuing loss remain; a competent

external oversight authority should acknowledge the referral, monitor deadlines and audit affected contracts.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2024 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q7: ABC Incorporated must respond to rapid AI expansion, a substantial increase in greenhouse-gas emissions, a net-zero commitment, innovation pressure and proposed environmental penalties.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 4. Numerical and contextual details should be taken from that official paper.

Model solution

Facts: AI-related data-centre growth conflicts with a public climate commitment and commercial competition.

Stakeholders: communities, workers, customers, shareholders, regulators, suppliers and future generations.

Constraints: the company cannot treat a pledge as performance, but an abrupt shutdown could destroy useful innovation and employment; measurement boundaries must be credible.

Options: continue and manage publicity; halt AI growth; rely mainly on offsets; or adopt independently verified absolute and intensity targets for efficiency, cleaner power, water, hardware and supply chains while continuing calibrated innovation. Inaction risks greenwashing; a total halt may be disproportionate; offset-only action leaves underlying demand unchanged.

Decision: choose the time-bound verified transition. Public interest, intergenerational justice and transparency outweigh short-term cost, while proportionality preserves innovation. Steelman: competitors without similar costs may erode the firm's market position and future capacity to invest. Milestones should therefore be ambitious but sequenced, technology-neutral and reviewed against both environmental and commercial evidence.

Implementation: commission external assurance, publish assumptions, link executive accountability to targets, price environmental costs into investment and support proportionate penalties with due process and equal criteria. Residual risk: clean-power scarcity and rebound demand may defeat efficiency gains; the board sustainability committee should monitor absolute emissions and trigger corrective capital allocation when the pathway is missed.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2024 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q10: Sneha chairs a hospital procurement process in which her financially stressed brother is a bidder, while management says it will support whatever decision she takes.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 8. The entry is condensed to preserve neutral routing.

Model solution

Facts: Sneha exercises procurement influence while a close family member competes for financial benefit.

Stakeholders: patients, hospital management, all bidders, her brother, Sneha and institutional credibility. Constraints: management trust does not remove the conflict; procurement must conclude on time and against defensible quality and cost criteria.

Options: score all bids herself; secretly disadvantage her brother; ask him to withdraw informally; or disclose the relationship in writing, recuse, refer evaluation to an unconflicted authority and apply pre-announced criteria. The first two options remain biased in opposite directions. Informal withdrawal solves one outcome but leaves no durable process.

Decision: disclose, recuse, refer and publish or consistently apply the criteria. Conflict of interest is a hard threshold; claimed personal integrity cannot make continued participation legitimate. Steelman: recusal may reveal private family hardship and delay urgently needed supplies. Disclosure should be limited to what the competent authority needs, and an alternate evaluator should be appointed immediately.

Implementation: record the relationship before final evaluation, cease all influence, preserve bid confidentiality and communicate the result uniformly. Residual risk: bidders may still perceive concealed influence or reverse discrimination. Management's compliance or audit function should review the scoring trail and require the same recusal in future tenders involving the brother.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2024 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q12: Dr Srinivasan faces pressure to accelerate a biotechnology trial despite deficiencies in informed consent and the exclusion of an unfavourable data point.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 9. The official paper controls the full narrative and subparts.

Model solution

Facts: vulnerable participants may not have received adequate informed consent, and unfavourable evidence has been excluded under commercial pressure. Stakeholders: participants, future patients, research staff, the ethics committee, regulator, company and scientific community. Constraints: valid consent and data integrity are threshold requirements; the scientist cannot alone substitute for the competent ethics body.

Options: continue unchanged; retrospectively regularise records; halt everything unilaterally; or disclose both lapses, restore the complete dataset, protect participants and ask the ethics committee to decide re-consent, suspension or continuation. Concealment and falsification fail legality and research ethics. Unilateral action may exceed role authority and weaken institutional review.

Decision: immediate written disclosure and referral to the ethics committee, with no further compromised enrolment. Duty to participants and truth in science outweigh timeline pressure. Steelman: interruption may delay a beneficial treatment and impose costs on participants already enrolled. The committee should therefore conduct urgent, evidence-based review rather than accept either concealment or indefinite delay.

Implementation: secure raw data, stop improper recruitment, arrange independent re-consent where directed, inform the board that continuation is institutionally controlled and protect reporters from retaliation. Residual risk: re-consent may itself pressure vulnerable participants and restored data may be mishandled; the ethics committee should appoint an independent monitor and conduct a follow-up site audit.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2025 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q7: Deputy Commissioner Vijay leads relief after a devastating hill disaster when his mother dies far away and the crisis worsens, creating competing personal and public duties.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\mains\UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 4.pdf, pages 4-5. The canonical Basic treatment supplies the controlling case method.

Model solution

Facts: Vijay directs continuing relief amid renewed danger, disrupted communications and personal bereavement. Stakeholders: victims, relief teams, his family, the deputy command, seniors and Vijay's wellbeing. Constraints: relief cannot pause; travel and communication are uncertain; any absence requires authorised, competent and recorded delegation.

Options: leave immediately through informal handover; remain and abandon the rites; rely only on remote management; or make a brief authorised absence after written delegation, intensive briefing and scheduled remote oversight. Nested dilemmas must be separated: personal duty versus public duty, fairness in relief allocation, and truthful communication versus public calm.

Decision: choose brief, tightly controlled delegation if a competent deputy and communications are genuinely available; otherwise remain until those safeguards exist. No illegality decides the case, so proportionality, continuity and compassion are weighted. Steelman: any absence during resumed rain may create a fatal command gap. Clear authority limits, check-ins and immediate return triggers convert that objection into design conditions.

Implementation: obtain senior authorisation, issue written delegation, publish the command arrangement internally, preserve existing triage criteria and define escalation triggers. Residual risk: deputy error or sudden deterioration survives; Vijay should maintain check-ins, return on trigger and personally lead an after-action review of decisions taken during the absence.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2025 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q9: PWD Secretary Subash holds confidential road-alignment information sought by his real-estate businessman son, while a Minister also signals that a relative's company should receive favourable treatment.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\mains\UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 4.pdf, page 7. The local official paper and canonical Basic treatment control details.

Model solution

Facts: Subash faces two linked improprieties: family demand for privileged information and ministerial pressure favouring a connected company. Stakeholders: landowners, bidders, taxpayers, the son and nephew, PWD staff, the Minister, Subash and public trust. Constraints: confidential information cannot be shared; tender and land decisions must use lawful authority and objective criteria.

Options: disclose selectively; refuse privately but continue alone; transfer the whole responsibility without explanation; or record both approaches, refuse disclosure, declare the family connection, recuse where that connection touches the decision, and route evaluation through an untainted committee using published criteria. Private refusal leaves pressure undocumented; unexplained transfer weakens accountability.

Decision: use the conflict sequence and written-order response together. Legality and conflict are hard thresholds, so family loyalty, secrecy assurances or political convenience cannot outweigh them. Steelman: formal escalation may damage working relations and delay a strategic project. Immediate committee-based routing and a concise professional record preserve both speed and integrity.

Implementation: secure alignment data, restrict access, seek written confirmation of improper directions, notify the competent superior or vigilance authority and audit communications and bid evaluation. Residual risk: proxies may still trade on leaked information or influence specifications. An independent procurement and land-acquisition review should monitor access logs, criteria and beneficial-interest declarations.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2025 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q10: engineer Rajesh faces an urgent culvert repair whose true cost exceeds delegated financial power, and a contractor proposes splitting the work to avoid superior sanction.

Source / ownership: Neutral demand verified against books\mains\UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 4.pdf, pages 8-9. Exact monetary and procedural facts must be checked in the official paper.

Model solution

Facts: public safety requires urgent repair, but the genuine requirement exceeds Rajesh's delegated authority and the contractor proposes artificial splitting. Stakeholders: commuters, nearby residents, contractors, the superior sanctioning authority, audit and Rajesh. Constraints: urgency is real; evading delegation is impermissible; only technically separable emergency work may be considered within existing power under the applicable procedure.

Options: split the same requirement; wait passively for normal sanction; undertake the full repair without authority; or record the danger, refer the full estimate urgently and execute only independently justified temporary stabilisation within lawful power while the permanent work is approved. Artificial splitting fails the legality and propriety threshold. Passive delay disregards foreseeable harm.

Decision: choose the phased lawful response only if engineering evidence establishes genuinely separate stabilisation. Public interest and proportionality then control among lawful options. Steelman: phasing may itself disguise splitting. Independent technical reasons, superior notice and later audit must therefore precede execution.

Implementation: send the full estimate and safety report immediately, document scope boundaries, use no contractor-designed paperwork, communicate temporary restrictions and seek expedited sanction. Residual risk: temporary work may fail or be perceived as evasion; the superior engineer should approve monitoring, inspect milestones and require internal audit before closure.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain why hard constraints should be mapped before options are generated in a GS-IV case study. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Hard constraints convert an ethical narrative into an administratively realistic decision. They include legality, delegated authority, jurisdiction, time, information, resources and institutional capacity. If a district officer lacks statutory power, an attractive promise cannot become a valid option merely because it appears compassionate.

The correct sequence is elimination before balancing. An unlawful disclosure, a conflicted decision or expenditure beyond delegated power is removed first. The surviving courses can then be compared through public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion. This prevents candidates from wasting words evaluating impossible choices.

Constraint mapping also improves hybrid design. An engineer may not sanction an entire urgent work, yet may lawfully secure a genuinely separable temporary stabilisation while referring the permanent repair upward. Thus constraints do not always paralyse action; they define the lawful space within which practical wisdom operates. A high-quality answer names the binding constraint, the competent authority and the feasible route around delay without evasion.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish hard-threshold checks from weighted checks in ethical case analysis. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Hard-threshold checks determine whether an option may remain under consideration. Legality is the clearest example: expected welfare cannot authorise an unlawful act. A genuine conflict of interest is similarly near-disqualifying; the officer must disclose and recuse rather than claim personal objectivity.

Weighted checks compare options that survive. Public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion can conflict. During triage, maximising lives saved may pull against priority to the most vulnerable. The candidate must state which factor is decisive in that context and protect the weaker factor through safeguards, review or communication.

The distinction produces a disciplined sequence: identify conflicts and legality; remove impermissible choices; apply moral theories and weighted checks to lawful alternatives; choose; then answer the strongest objection. Treating every consideration as equal invites vague balancing and may imply that sufficient benefit can purchase legality. Treating every value as absolute, conversely, prevents reasoned choice. Ethical maturity lies in firm thresholds followed by explicit, evidence-based weighting.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Show how nested-dilemma decomposition and steelmanning improve a complex case-study answer. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Nested-dilemma decomposition prevents one dramatic fact from swallowing the rest of the case. The 2025 Vijay-type disaster problem contains personal grief versus public duty, continuity and fairness of relief allocation, and honest communication versus panic control. Each tension should receive a compact independent pass through legality, public interest, proportionality, transparency and compassion before the results are integrated.

The method avoids muddled phrases such as balance both sides. Vijay's personal dilemma may support a brief authorised absence; the allocation dilemma still requires the deputy to retain published triage criteria; the communication dilemma requires verified, calibrated updates. Separate resolutions therefore become one coherent operational plan.

Steelmanning then tests the plan against its strongest credible objection. The serious objection is not that family duty is irrelevant, but that any command gap during renewed danger could cost lives. A mature answer accepts this risk and makes competent written delegation, scheduled contact and immediate-return triggers conditions of the decision.

The two devices serve different functions: decomposition clarifies what must be decided, while steelmanning tests whether the selected response survives informed criticism. Both must remain proportionate to the word limit; artificial sub-dilemmas and repeated counter-arguments create indecision rather than depth.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate the written-order response and ethical-dissent ladder as safeguards against improper administrative pressure. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Improper oral pressure is dangerous because it seeks compliance without accountability. The officer should record the instruction, seek written confirmation and place the legal, technical and ethical objection on the official record. This protects institutional memory, fixes responsibility and demonstrates independent professional judgment. The officer should continue lawful work while referral is pending unless the act would itself be unsafe or unlawful.

If the pressure persists, dissent should climb proportionately: competent internal reporting; an independent internal vigilance, audit or ethics tier; an authorised regulator, ombudsman or external authority; and public disclosure only when serious continuing harm and failed lawful alternatives justify that last step. When the normal superior is implicated, the compromised rung may be skipped, but evidence and lawful purpose remain essential.

The strongest objection is that formal recording can provoke retaliation or administrative delay. Therefore the response should be concise, factual, time-bound and supported by secure evidence and anti-retaliation measures where available. Resignation is not the automatic next rung: it is justified only when resistance is exhausted and departure protects public interest better than continued principled service.

Together, written reasons and graduated escalation turn private conscience into accountable institutional action without confusing courage with impulsive leakage or theatrical exit.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: A district faces severe water scarcity among households, hospitals, farmers and industry. Apply the complete case-study architecture to design an ethical allocation response. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Facts and dilemma: available water cannot meet all claims, while immediate survival needs and longer-term livelihoods conflict. Stakeholders include households, hospitals, vulnerable settlements, farmers, workers, industry, local bodies, ecosystems and future users. Constraints are the actual reservoir level, drinking-water law and policy, conveyance losses, time, uncertain rainfall and limited enforcement capacity.

Options are: retain historical quotas; use first-come political bargaining; impose an undifferentiated cut; or publish a tiered emergency allocation. The tiered course should protect minimum drinking, sanitation and critical-care needs first; reserve ecological and fire-safety minima; then distribute livelihood and industrial supplies through transparent necessity, efficiency and vulnerability criteria, with recycling and temporary restrictions.

Evaluation begins with legality and non-discrimination as thresholds. Consequentialism supports preventing death and maintaining essential services; duty ethics protects equal dignity and a basic minimum; proportionality rejects both unrestricted consumption and blanket closure. The decisive weighted considerations are urgency, vulnerability and avoidable harm. Steelman: prioritising urban hospitals and households may ruin farms and jobs. The plan therefore needs crop-saving rotations, fodder and income support, recycled industrial water and rapid loss reduction rather than simply transferring all scarcity to rural users.

Decision and implementation: constitute a multi-stakeholder drought cell, publish daily availability and criteria, meter bulk users, repair leaks, enforce restrictions uniformly and create an expedited appeal route. Communicate uncertainty honestly and revise allocations at fixed hydrological triggers.

Residual risk equals severe inherent scarcity minus conservation, prioritisation and augmentation controls, plus forecast and enforcement uncertainty. Capture by powerful users may remain. The district drought cell should publish allocation logs, commission independent audit and review impacts on vulnerable groups every week.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: A public-sector quality officer discovers that a safety-critical product failed tests, but senior management orders clearance to avoid losses and threatens retaliation. Decide. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Facts and dilemma: a failed safety result conflicts with management's commercial and reputational interests, and the officer faces personal retaliation. Stakeholders include consumers, workers, distributors, shareholders, the regulator, honest colleagues, management and the officer's family. Constraints include mandatory safety standards, release deadlines, evidence custody, the officer's limited authority and the possibility that the ordinary reporting line is compromised.

Options are: alter or ignore the result; delay silently; resign without reporting; or preserve the original test, record the oral direction, stop clearance within lawful authority and escalate with evidence to independent quality governance and, if required, the competent regulator. The first option fails legality, professional duty and public interest. Silent delay leaves the hazard active. Immediate resignation removes the witness and does not protect consumers.

Decision: choose evidence preservation, written refusal and graduated escalation. Deontology requires fidelity to safety and truth; consequences favour preventing mass harm; virtue ethics supports courage disciplined by prudence. Steelman: a false or non-representative failed test could destroy the enterprise and jobs. Therefore an independent confirmatory test may proceed under controlled custody, but the product must remain quarantined until the competent authority decides; tests cannot be repeated selectively until a desired result appears.

Implementation: timestamp and secure samples and raw data, request written confirmation, notify the independent quality committee, define a short regulator trigger, protect affected staff and prepare a truthful recall plan if distribution occurred. Communicate verified risk without sensationalism.

Residual risk includes retaliation, evidence tampering and supply shortage. The regulator or independent quality head should control access logs, witness the retest, monitor the officer's employment treatment and audit corrective action. Resignation becomes defensible only if all lawful channels fail and continued office would require personal falsification.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.